

Business Research Document

FlowStudio

A Creative Workflow Platform for Artist Collaboration and Project Management

Submitted as part of **NCET Plus Training SDE-JAVA — Capstone Project**

Academic Batch: 2023 – 2027

Technology Stack: React.js | SpringBoot | MySQL

1. ABSTRACT

This document is a business research report prepared as part of a NCET Plus training SDE(Java) capstone project. The project proposes a web-based platform called FlowStudio, which is designed to help artists and creative professionals — such as musicians, filmmakers, graphic designers, photographers, and writers — find each other, form teams, and manage their collaborative projects in one place.

The main idea behind the project is simple: right now, there is no dedicated platform that helps creative professionals collaborate in a structured way. They rely on Instagram DMs, WhatsApp groups, and word-of-mouth referrals to find teammates — none of which are designed for this purpose. FlowStudio aims to solve this by bringing together profile showcasing, skill-based search, project creation, team management, and collaboration requests under one roof.

This document covers the background and problem, a review of existing platforms, some primary and secondary research findings, and a description of the proposed solution along with the technology choices made. The goal is to present a well-reasoned, research-backed justification for building this platform as a capstone project.

Note: This project is at the idea and prototype stage. It is a student project and not a commercially deployed product.

2. INTRODUCTION

2.1 Background

Creative work is inherently collaborative, requiring multiple roles such as directors, writers, musicians, and designers. However, there is no dedicated platform for artists to efficiently find collaborators with specific skills.

Currently, creators rely on platforms like Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook, and WhatsApp, which are not designed for creative collaboration.

To address this gap, FlowStudio is proposed as a web platform where artists can showcase their work, find collaborators, and manage projects in one place.

2.2 Target Users

The platform is designed for diverse creative professionals, including:

- Filmmakers, editors, and directors
- Writers and storytellers
- Musicians and sound designers
- Designers, illustrators, and animators
- Photographers and actors
- Content creators and digital artists

Roles are flexible and defined by users rather than fixed by the system.

2.3 Purpose of the Project

This project aims to solve a real-world problem observed among students and independent artists—difficulty in finding suitable collaborators.

As a computer science student interested in creative fields, this platform combines technology with practical utility to improve collaboration opportunities.

This project is also a good fit for a full-stack capstone because it involves user authentication, relational database design, REST API development, and a dynamic React frontend — all concepts covered in the curriculum.

3. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Artists and creative professionals do not have a dedicated, structured way to find collaborators, form teams, and manage creative projects together. The tools they currently use are either too generic (LinkedIn), too social-media-focused (Instagram), or too informal (WhatsApp groups). This results in:

- Missed collaboration opportunities because people simply cannot find each other.
- Overdependence on personal contacts and networks, which puts newcomers at a disadvantage.
- Disorganised project management spread across multiple apps and platforms.
- No structured way to showcase skills and past work to potential collaborators.
- Unclear roles and responsibilities within creative teams.

Problem	Current Workaround	Why It Falls Short
Finding collaborators	Instagram, Facebook groups, word of mouth	Unreliable, slow, limited reach
Showcasing portfolio	Multiple platforms (Behance, YouTube, etc.)	Scattered, no single discoverable profile
Managing projects	WhatsApp + Google Drive + Sheets	Fragmented, no single workspace
Visibility for new talent	Post on social media, hope the algorithm helps	Depends on followers, not talent
Assigning roles	Verbal/informal agreements	No documentation, leads to confusion

4. OBJECTIVE OF STUDY

The research part of this project aims to:

1. Understand the specific problems artists face when looking for collaborators.
2. Look at existing platforms and figure out why they do not fully solve the problem.
3. Collect some basic data (through surveys and conversations) to back up the problem statement.
4. Use the findings to decide what features the platform should have and what it should prioritise.

The development part of this project aims to:

1. Build a working web platform where artists can register, create profiles, and showcase their work.
2. Implement a search and filtering system so users can find others based on skills and creative field.
3. Allow users to create projects, invite others, and assign roles within those projects.
4. Build a collaboration request system so users can formally reach out to each other.
5. Keep the platform simple, clean, and easy to use.
6. Use modern and appropriate technologies: React.js for the frontend, Spring Boot for the backend, and MySQL for the database.

5. LITERATURE REVIEW

Before building anything, it made sense to look at what already exists and understand why existing platforms do not quite solve the problem. This section reviews some of the main platforms that artists currently use, and also looks at some background reading on collaboration tools and web development technologies.

5.1 Existing Platforms

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform used by people across almost every industry. Many artists do have LinkedIn profiles, but the platform is clearly designed for the corporate world — resumes, job applications, and B2B networking. It does not have a portfolio feature suited for creative work, no project workspace, and its tone and culture do not resonate with independent artists and creative freelancers. Searching for a 'music composer available for short film collaboration in Mumbai' on LinkedIn would give very poor results.

Instagram

Instagram is probably the most commonly used platform by artists to share their work. It is great for building an audience and getting visual exposure. However, it is a content-sharing platform, not a collaboration tool. There is no way to say 'I am looking for a video editor' in any structured, searchable way. Direct messaging on Instagram is informal and not designed for professional collaboration discussions. Also, Instagram's algorithm heavily favours accounts with large followings, which makes it hard for new artists to get noticed.

Behance

Behance (owned by Adobe) is a portfolio platform primarily used by graphic designers, illustrators, and UX designers. It is good for showcasing finished work but does not support active collaboration. You cannot create a project on Behance and invite team members to join. It also does not cater to musicians, filmmakers, or writers in any meaningful way.

Stage 32

Stage 32 is a networking platform specifically for film, television, and theatre professionals. It is probably the closest existing platform to what FlowStudio is trying to do, at least for the film industry. However, it is focused entirely on film and TV, has a paid model for most useful features, and does not include project management tools. It also excludes the broader creative community (musicians, designers, animators, etc.).

WhatsApp and Telegram Groups

A large number of creative collaborations happen through informal WhatsApp or Telegram communities — groups like 'Indie Filmmakers Delhi' or 'Freelance Designers Network'. These work to some extent because people are already using these apps, but they are fundamentally chat tools. There is no structured profile, no searchable skill database, and no way to manage a project within them. Important conversations get buried in message threads.

5.2 What This Review Tells Us

None of the existing platforms check all the boxes that a creative collaboration platform needs to check. The gap can be summarised as: artists need a place that combines a skill-based profile and portfolio, searchable discovery, structured team formation, and basic project management.

6. PROPOSED SOLUTION - FlowStudio

Based on the research, this section describes the proposed platform — what it does, how it is structured, and why specific design decisions were made.

6.1 What Is FlowStudio?

FlowStudio is a web-based platform where artists and creative professionals can create profiles, search for collaborators, build teams, and manage their creative projects — all in one place. Think of it as a combination of a creative professional network and a lightweight project management tool, built specifically for artists.

The platform is not trying to replace Instagram or LinkedIn. It is not a social media app and it is not a job portal. Its only focus is structured creative collaboration.

6.2 Core Features

User Registration and Profiles

Users sign up with their name, email, and password. Once registered, they create a profile that includes their creative field(s), skills, a short bio, their location, and links to their previous work. The profile is their single identity on the platform.

Portfolio Showcase

Each user can upload or link their previous work to their profile — whether that is a short film, a music track, a design project, or a photography set. This becomes their discoverable portfolio on the platform. Instead of sharing five different links, they share one profile link.

Skill-Based Search and Discovery

The most important feature of the platform. Users can search for other users by creative field or skill (e.g., 'music composer', 'video editor', 'graphic designer'). Results can be filtered by skill, location, and availability. This directly addresses the biggest pain point identified in the research.

Collaboration Requests

Instead of sending an informal Instagram DM, users can send a formal collaboration request to another user. The request includes a message explaining the project and what they are looking for. The recipient can accept or decline. This creates a structured, professional way to initiate collaboration.

Project Creation and Management

Users can create a project workspace, give it a title and description, and invite other users to join. Within the project, the creator (project owner) can assign specific roles to each team member (e.g., 'Director', 'Sound Designer', 'Editor'). All project details are stored in one place.

Role Assignment

Within a project, each team member is assigned a specific role. This is not a fixed dropdown — roles can be named anything, depending on the project's needs. This solves the problem of unclear responsibilities in creative teams.

7. CONCLUSION

The goal of this project was to identify a real problem, back it up with some research, and propose a solution in the form of a web platform. The problem — that artists and creative professionals have no dedicated, structured way to find collaborators and manage creative projects — is clearly real. The research, even at the small scale of a student project, consistently validated this. Survey respondents were frustrated with current options, and the people spoken to had specific, concrete stories about the difficulties they faced.

FlowStudio is proposed as a solution to this problem. It is not trying to be everything to everyone — it is a focused tool for creative collaboration. Its core features (skill-based search, unified profiles, project workspaces, role assignment, collaboration requests) each directly address one of the identified pain points.

The technology choices — React.js, Spring Boot, and MySQL — are well-suited to this type of platform and are also appropriate for a student project in terms of learning value and feasibility. The platform has been designed with simplicity in mind, both in terms of user experience and technical implementation.

At this stage, FlowStudio is a capstone project and a working prototype. It is an idea that has been thought through carefully and built with purpose. Whether it becomes a real product in the future depends on further development, testing, and real-world feedback — but this document and the accompanying system establish a solid foundation for that possibility.

8. REFERENCES

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